Next-Level Recommendation Worksheet

Gather the evidence, map it to the next level and write a recommendation that is clear, complete and fair.

How to use it. You may not be the decision maker. Your job is to make the case easy to say yes to. Collect evidence from at least the last six months.

1. The person and the ask

Name, current level and target level

Who decides, and what they need to see
Format, deadline, criteria

2. What the next level asks for

CRITERION AT THE NEXT LEVEL	WHERE THE PERSON IS TODAY	GAP

3. Evidence, mapped to each criterion

CRITERION	EVIDENCE (WORK, OUTCOME, DATE)	IMPACT (METRIC OR OUTCOME)	VOICE (WHO SAID IT)

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4. Beyond the work

Multidisciplinary range
Product, engineering, data, business and leadership partners

Growth over time
What they could not do a year ago

5. Risks, and how we will support

Honest gaps
What the decision maker may question

Support plan if approved
The first ninety days at the new level

6. The recommendation

- [ ] A deck, with one slide per criterion and the evidence on it
- [ ] An email, short, with the evidence linked
- [ ] Both: the deck attached to the email

The summary: three sentences a decision maker can repeat
Who they are, what they already do at the next level, and what you are asking for

7. Before you send

- [ ] Every claim has evidence or a name behind it
- [ ] The evidence maps to the criteria, not to effort alone
- [ ] I checked the case against others at the same level, for bias
- [ ] The person knows I am recommending them and what happens next

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